



CARGO WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 25 APRIL 2026 - 24 MAY 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Cargo-security reporting this period centred on inland transport activity, with cargo theft in transit and truck hijacking the clearest drivers of exposure. Reporting was most concentrated in Indonesia. Overall severity was predominantly moderate, with a minority of events reaching high severity. This keeps route security and driver integrity the main operational priority, with route planning and driver vetting the controls most in need of reinforcement across the region.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 25 Apr - 24 May 2026	TOTAL RECORDS 46 Cargo Watch this period	HIGHEST SEVERITY High Highest rating this period
TOP ISSUE TYPE Cargo theft in transit 20 records	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY Indonesia 6 records	LATEST INCIDENT 23 May 2026

CARGO SECURITY REPORTING BY COUNTRY

Reporting was concentrated in Indonesia (13% of located incidents).

WEEKLY TREND AND ACTIVITY

Activity eased during the final reporting week relative to the preceding week.

ENFORCEMENT ACTIVITY

15 enforcement outcomes reported this period (arrests, seizures or recoveries), shown separately and excluded from the incident totals above.

24 May 2026 India - Ahmedabad · Weapons / contraband seizure (cargo / port) Counterfeit of Tobacco - Ahmedabad, India Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)	SEVERITY: MODERATE
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21 May 2026

SEVERITY: LOW

Vietnam · Weapons / contraband seizure (cargo / port)
Counterfeit of Food & Drink - Vietnam
Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)

16 May 2026

SEVERITY: MODERATE

Vietnam · Weapons / contraband seizure (cargo / port)
Counterfeit of Pharmaceuticals - Vietnam
Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)

16 May 2026

SEVERITY: MODERATE

Thailand · Weapons / contraband seizure (cargo / port)
Counterfeit of Pharmaceuticals - Thailand
Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)

12 May 2026

SEVERITY: LOW

India · Weapons / contraband seizure (cargo / port)
Counterfeit of Food & Drink - India
Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)

11 May 2026

SEVERITY: LOW

Vietnam · Weapons / contraband seizure (cargo / port)
Counterfeit of Food & Drink - Vietnam
Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)

09 May 2026

SEVERITY: MODERATE

Indonesia - Tangerang · Arrest of cargo crime group
Traffic Patrol (PJR Korlantas) Arrests 4 Suspects for Truck Tire Theft on Tangerang-Merak Toll Road
Status: Suspects arrested
Source: Korlantas Polri

08 May 2026

SEVERITY: MODERATE

Bangladesh · Arrest of cargo crime group
Truck robbery including aluminum in Bagerhat; 2 arrested
Status: Suspects arrested
Source: Bangladesh Sangbad Sangstha (BSS)

05 May 2026

SEVERITY: LOW

Thailand · Weapons / contraband seizure (cargo / port)
Counterfeit of Food & Drink - Thailand
Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)

01 May 2026

SEVERITY: HIGH

New Zealand · Arrest of cargo crime group
Truck hijack on Waikato Expressway near Hamilton, police make arrests
Status: Suspects arrested
Source: Stuff (NZ, via Google News)

29 Apr 2026

Malaysia · Arrest of cargo crime group
Cargo theft syndicate busted after truck hijack in Selangor

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: The Star (Malaysia)

SEVERITY: MODERATE

28 Apr 2026

Vietnam · Arrest of cargo crime group
Truck hijack on QL51 near Bien Hoa, Dong Nai police arrest organised crew

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: Tuoi Tre News (via Google News)

SEVERITY: MODERATE

27 Apr 2026

Papua New Guinea · Arrest of cargo crime group
Truck hijack on Highlands Highway near Mount Hagen, Western Highlands police make arrests

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: Post Courier (PNG, via Google News)

SEVERITY: HIGH

27 Apr 2026

Laos · Arrest of cargo crime group
Truck hijack on Route 9 near Densavanh, Savannakhet police make arrests

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: Laotian Times (via Google News)

SEVERITY: MODERATE

26 Apr 2026

Cambodia · Arrest of cargo crime group
Cross-border freight robbery at Bavet checkpoint, Svay Rieng police make arrests

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: Khmer Times (via Google News)

SEVERITY: MODERATE

SITUATION

Cargo exposure this period was led by inland transport activity and concentrated in Indonesia, with cargo theft in transit and truck hijacking the clearest patterns.

WHAT MATTERS

- Cargo theft in transit centred on Philippines: this matters because it directly stresses route security and driver integrity, raising exposure for cargo owners.

IMPLICATIONS

- The reported cargo theft in transit in India confirms inland transport as a live exposure point for affected consignments.

WATCH NEXT

- Repeat hits on the same corridor, operator or load type.

KEY INCIDENTS

Incidents that best illustrate the main operational patterns identified during the reporting period.

28 Apr 2026

SEVERITY: HIGH

India - Bengaluru · Cargo theft in transit

Robbery of Jewellery/Precious Metals - Bengaluru, India

Operational relevance: Points to exposure during road movement on predictable corridors, where route planning and in-transit tracking are the main defences.

Source: TAPA EMEA (APAC)

27 Apr 2026

SEVERITY: HIGH

Bangladesh · Truck hijacking

Truck hijack on Dhaka-Chattogram highway near Cumilla, freight consignment looted

Operational relevance: Points to exposure during road movement on predictable corridors, where route planning and in-transit tracking are the main defences.

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: Prothom Alo (English, via Google News)

28 Apr 2026

SEVERITY: MODERATE

Australia · Other cargo security incident

Brisbane diesel siphoning ring busted by Queensland Police at transport yards

Operational relevance: Records a cargo-security event the reporting does not place precisely in the supply chain.

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: ABC News Australia (via Google News)

01 May 2026

SEVERITY: MODERATE

Laos · Cargo theft in transit

Cross-border freight robbery at Boten checkpoint, Luang Namtha police investigating

Operational relevance: Points to exposure during road movement on predictable corridors, where route planning and in-transit tracking are the main defences.

Status: Suspects arrested

Source: Laotian Times (via Google News)

POLESTAR VIEW

Cargo-security exposure this period is inland transport-led and concentrated around Indonesia, and most consistent with opportunistic, financially motivated theft, not a coordinated or politically driven campaign. The data supports a picture of cargo theft in transit and truck hijacking affecting inland transport exposure, with moderate severity most common and losses on cargo owners and logistics providers. It does not support claims of an organised cross-border network, a confirmed insider or seal-compromise dimension, or a statistically meaningful surge, none of which the records establish. Reporting is drawn from open sources with only partial enrichment: loss values, cargo types and movement stage are frequently unstated, so totals and shares are indicative, not exhaustive. In the near term, further inland transport incidents of a similar character are likely in and around Indonesia, absent a change in local enforcement or operators' own measures. Overall analytical confidence is moderate to high, reflecting corroborating volume against open-source and enrichment limitations.

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